



Password Policy



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Document Information

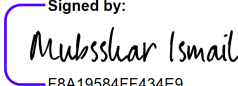
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1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to establish a standard criterion for creating and setting secure passwords, the protection of those passwords for accessing ibex managed systems and applications.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all IBEX employees and third-party personnel that have access to IBEX systems and/or applications.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Roles	Responsibilities
System / Application Owners	Ensure that the standard criteria are applied in their domain
Users	Adherence to this policy

4. Policy

4.1. Password Management

1. New passwords shall be provided to the users in a secure manner with an appropriate proof-of-identity of the intended user.
2. Users shall be provided initially with a secure temporary password. The temporary password must be changed immediately upon first use.
3. Temporary passwords shall be provided when users forget their passwords and only after verification of user's identity.
4. Passwords shall be forced to change every 90 days.
5. Passwords shall always be encrypted, both at rest and in transit using recognized industry standards.
6. Passwords/passphrases for any application and system accounts used for interactive login shall not be hard coded in scripts, configuration/property files, or bespoke and custom source code.
7. Password shall be rendered unreadable when logging in.
8. Vendor supplied default passwords shall be modified before the system is used in the operational environment.
9. Removal of development, test and/or custom application accounts, user IDs, and passwords shall be ensured before applications are moved to production.
10. Passwords for all domain accounts shall be centrally managed.

4.2. Password Configurations

1. Unique passwords should be ensured for all user accounts.
2. Passwords shall be forced to change every 90 days.
3. User account shall be locked after three consecutive unsuccessful logon attempts.
4. Minimum passwords length shall be ensured as under:

Account Type	Password Length
Standard user account	Twelve (12) characters
Delegated and test accounts	Sixteen (16) characters
All service accounts*	Twenty (20) characters

*also applicable for service accounts with passwords set to never expire.

5. The user shall be prohibited to use the last fifteen passwords.
6. Password shall not consist solely of a word with slight modifications, and are not a modification or increment of a recent password for the account.
7. Technical controls shall be implemented to detect commonly used, expected, or compromised passwords. Additionally, users shall be notified/required to change their passwords immediately if there is evidence of compromised password.
8. Users shall be required to login in again after an idle session of 5 min.
9. Passwords shall contain characters from at least three of the following four classes:

Class	Examples
Uppercase letters	A, B, C
Lowercase letters	a, b, c
Numerals	0, 1, 2
Non-alphanumeric (special characters)	#, &, !, %, @, ?, -, *

4.3. Password Usage

1. Users shall be responsible and accountable for the selection, use and management of their passwords or passphrases.
2. Passwords shall never be shared with anyone under any circumstances.
3. Passwords shall be changed whenever there is any indication of possible system or password compromise.
4. Passwords shall not be easily guessable, avoiding common words, patterns, or personal information.
5. Passwords must not contain:
 - a. Username, First and/or last name; or,
 - b. A single word from the dictionary with a number or special character at the beginning or end
 - c. Derivatives of user-IDs, and common character sequences such as "123456"
 - d. Personal details such as spouse's name, automobile license plate, social security number, and birthday

- e. Any part of speech. e.g., proper names, geographical locations, common acronyms, and slangs etc.
- 6. Passwords for use in ibex domain shall never be shared or revealed to anyone else regardless of the circumstances.
- 7. Passwords shall not be written down or stored in an unsecure manner.

5. Enforcement

Any employee found to have violated this policy may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including immediate termination of employment.

6. Definitions and Abbreviations

Word / Abbreviations	Descriptions/ Definition
HOD	Head of Department
Passphrase	Sentence like string of words used for authentication that is longer than a traditional password, easy to remember and difficult to crack
Delegate Account	Accounts with delegated rights to perform desired task only. This includes Domain, Network and DB admin accounts, IT Support accounts and Service Desk accounts
Service Accounts	account created to provide an identity for a system required to perform explicit service

7. Revision History

Version	Date	Details of Changes	Change By	Reviewed By	Approved By
1.1	10/30/2006	Initial Draft	John Richards	IS Committee	
1.2	05/03/2016	Policy Reviewed	Syed Qamber	M. Atif Naseem	Mubsshar Ismail
1.3	05/09/2018	Password expiry exception for Service Accounts	Muqet Kamal	M. Atif Naseem	Mubsshar Ismail
1.4	04/25/2019	Changed minimum password length	Muqet Kamal	M. Atif Naseem	Mubsshar Ismail
1.5	2/12/2021	Minor Changes	Muhammad Shahzad	M. Atif Naseem	Mubsshar Ismail
1.6	3/8/2022	Minor Changes	Muhammad Shahzad	M. Atif Naseem	Mubsshar Ismail
1.7	2/16/2023	Minor Changes in accordance with PCI v4.0 and HITRUST standard	Sidra Maryam	M. Atif Naseem Muhammad Shahzad	Mubsshar Ismail – VP IT Sec
1.8	2/19/2024	Changes added in accordance to PCI v 4.0 & current practices	Sidra Maryam	M. Atif Naseem M. Shahzad Muqet Kamal	Mubsshar Ismail
1.9	2/4/2025	Password usage and requirement statement segregated	Hassan Abbas Sidra Maryam	M. Atif Naseem M. Shahzad	Mubsshar Ismail
1.10	2/24/2025	Updated in-line with GOPP Nov-2024	Abdullah Hasan Tufail Sidra Maryam	M. Atif Naseem M. Shahzad	Mubsshar Ismail
2.0	6/19/2025	Revision in the password reset date	Sidra Maryam	Muhammad Shahzad	Mubsshar Ismail